Appear AI Weekly Brief: Positioning Decision

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Recommendation: a weekly intelligence brief called **The Answer Engine Brief**, sent by Appear AI every Tuesday to two lists: existing customers and leads that never converted. Everything else we build (template, signup page, data pull, promotion) follows from the calls below.

Decision	Recommendation
Name	The Answer Engine Brief
Brand	Appear AI. No second brand, The Rank Collective stays out of it
Promise	The buyer questions in your market, which brands answer engines name, and what changed this week
Audience	Existing customers and leads that never converted. Same issue, different footer CTA
Not for	Beginners, people wanting Appear AI news, agencies hunting templates, anyone outside a considered purchase market
Tone	Intelligence brief, never a company update
Send slot	Every Tuesday. Time not locked: local time per reader, or 12:00 ET

1. Name and brand

The Answer Engine Brief, by Appear AI. It runs under Appear AI, not The Rank Collective.

- **Why Appear AI:** every issue should make Appear AI the obvious name in the category. A second brand splits that credit, needs its own domain, sender reputation, design and social presence, and we have no team to run it.
- **Why this name:** it uses our locked phrase "answer engines", says what the reader gets (a brief, not a newsletter) and reads well in an inbox sender line: *Appear AI, The Answer Engine Brief*.
- **Sender:** a named person at Appear AI (Grischa), not a no reply address. People open emails from people.

- **Backups if the name is taken or tests badly:** *Buyer Questions Weekly* or *The Appear AI Brief*.

2. The promise

> **Every week, see the buyer questions your market is asking answer engines, which brands get recommended in the answers, and what changed since last week, pulled from Appear AI's own tracking data and nowhere else.**

What makes it impossible to get elsewhere is the data. Anyone can write opinions about AI search. Only we see the same buyer questions tracked week after week across answer engines, for every client we work with. Each issue must contain at least one finding straight from that data. On a quiet week the issue gets shorter, but it still ships with that one finding.

Every issue follows the same four blocks so readers know what they are getting:

1. **The shift:** the one biggest change in how answer engines answered buyer questions this week.
2. **Who got named:** brands that gained or lost recommendations, and the likely reason.
3. **The question to watch:** one buyer question growing fast that most brands are not answering yet.
4. **One move:** a single thing the reader can do before next Tuesday.

3. Who gets it, and who it is not for

Gets it: two lists, one issue. The body is identical for both, only the footer CTA changes, so we still write just one brief a week. The reader on both lists is the same person: a head of marketing, growth or demand gen at a brand whose buyers ask answer engines before they buy.

List	Why they get it	Footer CTA	What we measure
Existing customers	Shows the category is moving every week, keeps Appear AI front of mind at renewal, gives them something to forward to their boss	See how your brand did this week (link to their dashboard or account manager)	Opens, forwards, expansion conversations

List	Why they get it	Footer CTA	What we measure
Leads that never converted	Keeps us in their inbox with real value instead of "just checking in". When their timing changes, we are the name they remember	Get a free check of your buyer questions (book a call)	Replies, calls booked, revived deals

Before the first send to old leads: permission is confirmed for both lists, so no opt in email is needed. The first issue opens with one line on why they are getting it, and every issue has a one click unsubscribe. A clean, smaller list beats a big list that lands in spam.

Explicitly not for:

- **Beginners** who need "what is AI search" explained. We assume the reader already knows answer engines matter.
- **People who want Appear AI news.** No feature launches, hires or funding updates in the body.
- **SEO tacticians** looking for keyword lists, schema tricks or prompt hacks.
- **Agencies and freelancers** looking for templates to resell to their own clients.
- **Impulse purchase brands** where nobody asks an answer engine before buying.

Writing for everyone makes it useful to no one. When in doubt, cut what the "for" reader already knows.

4. Tone: intelligence brief, not company update

It should read like a briefing an analyst hands a busy executive: findings first, short, confident, no fluff. The reader should finish it in under 5 minutes and feel they know something their competitors do not.

Intelligence brief (do)	Company update (don't)
Lead with the finding and its number	Lead with "This week at Appear AI..."
"Answer engines now name 3 brands, not 5, for this buyer question"	"We're excited to share..."
Name real brands and real buyer questions	Talk in vague trends
One clear takeaway per block	Long essays and hot takes
Plain words, short sentences	Jargon like GEO, LLMO, AEO stacks

Intelligence brief (do)	Company update (don't)
Appear AI appears once, in the footer CTA	Product pitches in the body

Length: 300 to 450 words. Weekly means shorter, it should take 3 minutes to read. **Format:** plain, text first email with one chart at most. **Voice:** a smart colleague, never a brand.

5. Fixed slot

Every Tuesday. Send time still open (see below).

- **Why Tuesday:** past the Monday inbox cleanup, and it leaves the rest of the week for the "one move" to get done.
- **Send time, not decided yet:** both lists mix US and Europe. Option A: send at 10:00 in each reader's local time, if our email tool supports it and contacts have a timezone. Option B: one send at 12:00 ET, which is 18:00 CET, so Europe gets it at the end of their day. A is better for opens, B is simpler.
- **Weekly rhythm:** Friday data pull, Monday draft and review, Tuesday send. One owner, about 3 hours a week.
- **The slot never moves.** Missing a week costs more trust than a thinner issue.
- **Watch fatigue:** weekly is a lot for leads. If lead unsubscribes go above 1% per send for 3 weeks in a row, move that list to every other week and keep customers weekly.

Locked language

Use **"buyer questions"** and **"answer engines"** everywhere: subject lines, signup page, body, social posts. Never swap in "prompts", "queries", "LLMs", "AI chatbots", "GEO" or "AEO".

Approval

- [ ] Name and Appear AI brand approved
- [ ] Promise approved
- [ ] Two lists and their footer CTAs approved
- [ ] Not for list approved
- [ ] Tone rules approved
- [ ] Weekly Tuesday slot approved

Open question: does our email tool support local time sends, and do contacts have a timezone field (decides option A or B)?